

NORTHFIELD & VALE RETAIL GROUP

Quarterly Customer Complaint Summary

Product Line: Electronics & Accessories | Quarter: Q1 2024 (Jan-Mar) | Prepared by: Customer

Experience Analytics Team | Date Issued: April 8, 2024

1. SUMMARY

During Q1 2024, the Customer Experience team logged 412 complaints related to the Electronics & Accessories product line, a 9% increase over Q4 2023 (378 complaints). The increase is primarily attributed to the launch of the AuraSound WB-200 wireless earbuds and associated Bluetooth pairing issues.

2. COMPLAINT VOLUME BY CATEGORY

- Product defect / malfunction: 168 complaints (41%)
- Battery life shorter than advertised: 79 complaints (19%)
- Shipping damage: 61 complaints (15%)
- Difficulty with returns/refund processing: 54 complaints (13%)
- Misleading product description: 31 complaints (8%)
- Other: 19 complaints (4%)

3. TOP PRODUCTS BY COMPLAINT COUNT

1. AuraSound WB-200 Wireless Earbuds - 97 complaints. Most common issue: intermittent Bluetooth disconnection after firmware update 1.3.2. 2. VoltEdge 65W GaN Charger - 54 complaints. Most common issue: charger overheating during fast-charge mode. 3. PixelClear 27" Monitor - 48 complaints. Most common issue: dead pixels reported within first two weeks of use. 4. HomeHub Smart Plug 4-Pack - 33 complaints. Most common issue: devices randomly disconnecting from Wi-Fi network. 5. StrideFit Fitness Tracker - 29 complaints. Most common issue: heart rate sensor inaccuracy during workouts.

4. REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

Northeast region stores accounted for 34% of complaints, followed by West (27%), Midwest (22%), and South (17%). The Northeast concentration correlates with higher AuraSound WB-200 sell-through in that region.

5. RESOLUTION METRICS

- Average time to resolution: 4.2 days (target: 5 days)
- Complaints resolved via replacement unit: 61%
- Complaints resolved via refund: 29%
- Complaints resolved via store credit: 10%
- Customer satisfaction score post-resolution (CSAT): 3.7 / 5.0

6. ROOT CAUSE NOTES

Engineering has identified the AuraSound WB-200 Bluetooth issue as a firmware-level bug in the pairing handshake protocol. A patch (firmware 1.3.4) is scheduled for release in May 2024. The VoltEdge charger overheating issue has been escalated to the supplier's quality assurance team for a component-level review of the GaN chipset.

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Expedite firmware 1.3.4 rollout and proactively notify affected customers via email.
- Temporarily reduce VoltEdge charger promotional placement pending supplier review.
- Add a battery-life disclosure clarification to StrideFit product listing pages.
- Increase QA sampling rate for PixelClear monitors from 1-in-200 to 1-in-100 units.

This report is confidential and intended for internal distribution to Category Management, Engineering, and Executive Leadership only.